# Space Cadet

a solo starfaring gamebook by Will Kibel

## Welcome, Cadet, to the Galactic Corps!

We're so glad you've joined the team.

You will be stationed on the diplomatic vessel Nautilus, a class-L star jumper currently on year five of a ten-year mission to bring peace and unified commerce to the yet-to-be-civilized galaxy.

Before you start your journey, please inscribe the following on the next page: your name, your gender identification, your species identification, your planet of origin, any allergies you may have, and your signature catchphrase, which may be no more than 8 words in length.

Then, rolling a 6-sided polyhedron of your choice, determine your stats. There's a wide variety of Cadets who rise through the ranks of our training program, so let us know what one singular thing you specialize in (by adding 2 to the polyhedron roll of your choice)! These stats will help to give us some indicator of the outcome every time you perform a significant task.

Each cadet starts with 20 hit points. You will reduce some number of hit points every time you are hit - be sure to log this on your Cadet sheet by marking them off, for the sake of our record-keeping. Don't worry - there is plenty of medical technology available to you that can be used to get you back in tip-top shape, should you find yourself hurt, burnt, impaled, maimed, mauled, mutilated, lacerated, disintegrated, or otherwise inconvenienced in the name of diplomacy.

The Nautilus has no default onboard weapon capabilities, as it is a diplomatic vessel and any skirmishes should occur individually and not with proprietary Corps technology. It does, however, have shields in case you find yourself pursued by those unwilling to civilize. For the sake of simplicity, we have boiled this down to mirror your own "hit points." Should the Nautilus take any damage during your travels, please report it. Any unreported damage will result in suspension and a fine of a minimum of 600,000 galactic credits.

You will find yourself equipped with several tools, but who knows what more may follow in your journey among the stars! If you do pick up a new item of interest, please record it in your Inventory! If you are shown to be hiding an item of interest from the Galactic Corps, the result will be your immediate suspension and further discipline following Code 83-s4b (see Appendix M: Legalities for more details).

You will also find attached a ledger of the crew of the Nautilus, with a basic overview of each of their roles and capabilities. Should you add anyone else to the crew in your journeys, you may inscribe their names and relevant details in the ledger as well. Please note that they will not be eligible for Galactic Corps health insurance or dental insurance.

# NAME:

Gender:
Species:
Planet of Origin:
Allergies:
Signature Catchphrase:

_____ _____ _____ _____
_____ _____ _____ _____!

## STATS

| | |
|---|---|
| DIPLOMACY | |
| NAVIGATION | |
| ENGINEERING | |
| WEAPONS HANDLING | |
| PSYCHIC RESISTANCE | |

## HIT POINTS:

[ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ]
[ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ]

## INVENTORY:

- *1x Galactic Corps Cadet Pin*
- *1x Translat-X Mobile Unit*
-

# NAUTILUS

## SHIELDS:

[ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ]
[ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ]

## CREW MEMBERS:

Captain - Eileen Wickersham
5 | 6 | 2 | 4 | 2
Hit Points: __/30
Reputation: [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ]

Chief Operations Officer - Bill Lester
4 | 2 | 5 | 5 | 1
Hit Points: __/30
Reputation: [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ]

Chief Engineer - Josephine Phon
1 | 2 | 6 | 3 | 4
Hit Points: __/30
Reputation: [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ]

Security Officer - Jon Rodriguez
2 | 4 | 1 | 6 | 3
Hit Points: __/30
Reputation: [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ]

Political Scientist - Sebastien Montclair
6 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 5
Hit Points: __/30
Reputation: [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ]

Intellect Coordinator - Zeeb Greegle
4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 6
Hit Points: __/30
Reputation: [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ]

## Combat

Personal Combat

Not everyone you meet on your journey across the stars is going to be peaceful - at least, not without some strongarming. Combat is relatively simple. It consists of two phases: one where you and your allies can deal damage, and one where your enemies can deal damage.

To calculate damage, you roll a D6 and add your Weapons Handling stat. You can only target one enemy of your choice at a time. The enemies will choose their target randomly from you and your allies, unless they have a specific reason to want one of you dead more than the others.

Improvised Moves

We recognize that not all moves performed in combat may be neatly applicable to the Corps' combat framework. Therefore, if you make a move that is abnormal, innovative, or otherwise unorthodox, you can roll a D6. A four or higher means that your Improvised Move was successful. A successful Improvised Move deals damage equal to a D6 roll plus the appropriate stat (may not always be Weapons Handling!)

Ship Combat

ohhhh noooo idk
would like this to be in depth!

## Reputation

You can earn up to 5 reputation points with each crew member on the ship. This will affect the options that are available to you later on - if you have a higher reputation, your compatriots will trust you more.

1.
You step off your pod and into the ship proper, breathing in the musty air of the Nautilus' cargo hold. The "Galactic Corps" logo behind you shines bright amongst the rust and debris. Your uniform is freshly pressed, though it has already begun collecting some grime from the air around it.

Six weeks ago, you finished your on-world training as a Cadet in the Galactic Corps. Today, you begin your off-world training, stationed aboard the Nautilus. You're here to accompany the crew on their mission of diplomacy, visiting other worlds and assimilating them into the Corps. It's all you've dreamed of since you were little, and now you're finally here.

Your mission briefing told you to head to the bridge of the Nautilus and meet the captain, Eileen Wickersham, there for further instructions. Yellow lines on the floor clearly delineate where to walk. To the left, "BRIDGE." To the right, "CENTRAL ENGINEERING." Straight ahead, "LIBRARY."

To turn left, go to 2.
To turn right, go to 3.
To continue straight, go to 4.

2.
go straight to the bridge

3.
You turn right and head down the steel hallway. The rust of the cargo hold continues down the hall, heading towards a mechanical whirring noise that grows louder and louder as you approach. You have to duck a little to enter the doorframe, but you find yourself in Central Engineering. It's a large room, full of tools you recognize from your Cadet training, and machines you don't.

However, below the mechanical whirr is some sort of chattering. You look around to try to scope out the source, and then you see it - a swarm of Lyrats, huddled underneath a massive turbine. As you approach, most scatter, but a few stay there, gnawing slowly on the pneumatic cords of the turbine. You pick up a stun-wrench from the bench next to you. Time to earn your stars, Cadet.

Enter COMBAT with the 5 Lyrats.

> **LYRAT**
> *a small creature from Vorbulon-4. attracted to electricity. the scourge of many a mechanic.*
> HP: 5 | WH: 2

After concluding combat, go to 5.

4.
You enter the ship's internal library. Hunched over a desk, poring over some data drive, is a tall, lanky Bleegian - a sort of humanoid amphibian from the planet Zetrex sporting two sets of eyes. They glance at you. "Fresh blood, eh?"

You shrug. The Bleegian shakes themselves off, flinging a few globs of mucus onto the nearby datashelves. "Well, if you're looking to do some reading before you get oriented, you can peruse the shelves. Let me know if anything sticks out to you. Name's Zeeb."

To thank Zeeb for their help, go to 6.
To quietly and awkwardly shuffle over to the bookshelves, go to 7.

5.
Maybe your nickname will be "The Exterminator." Maybe you're a little too trigger-happy. Either way, the Lyrats are taken care of. You shout your classic catchphrase, feeling quite proud of yourself.

A small woman scrambles out from behind a nearby workbench. "My God, what are you doing? Can you please take it easy?" She lifts her welding goggles up, resting them on her forehead. "There's no need for all that ruckus. I really don't mind the Lyrats."

She squints at you. "As a matter of fact, who are you? Are you the new Cadet from Corps?" You nod emphatically.

"The name's Phon," she says, reaching out for a handshake (a motion you willingly oblige), "Chief Engineer. This is CE, Central Engineering. Everything that makes the Nautilus tick is here, in the belly of the beast. What's *your* specialty?"

[5 options depending on the specialty you picked in character creation. opt-in to becoming engineer's apprentice?]

idea: meta-game where there are isolated passages (that you can’t reach naturally) that contain important information